

BALLET POSITIONS

In 1661, King Louis XIV of France founded a Royal Academy of Dancing. The Academy devised rules for the correct ballet steps, based on five main positions of the feet. The positions were planned to give a balance to any position of the body. To this day there have been only a few minor changes made to these positions.

- Why do you think that, since 1661, there have been so few changes made to these positions?

SHEPHERD'S PURSE

Shepherd's Purse is a herb that is a member of the mustard family. It has a tap root and jagged edged leaves. The flowers grow at the ends of the slender stems. They are small, white and rather delicate. Commonly seen growing in wastelands and fields everywhere, it is often used in herbal medicine. It is, however, regarded as a curse in most gardens.

- Do you think Shepherd's Purse is commonly grown by gardeners? Why do you say that?

CHOCOLATE CHIP THIEF

"Who picked the chocolate chips out of these biscuits?" she demanded to know. Mum was standing by the trays of newly baked biscuits that had been had left to cool on the kitchen bench.

When it came to the extras in the food division, David preferred an apple or a sandwich. He would eat only small amounts of sugary food. Bill loved biscuits, cakes and pastries. He was an athlete and said he needed the fuel. Peter would eat anything that he could. He was only three years old and needed a lot of looking after.

Bill said it wasn't fair to accuse him. He'd just got back from a long run. Peter, rubbing his hands on his sweatshirt, said "Not me!" David shrugged his shoulders as if to say "As if!"

- Who do you think picked the chocolate chips out of the biscuits? Why do you say that?
- Do you think it was fair to think that Bill might be guilty? Why do you say that?

THE LOST EMPIRE

Looking up at all the skyscrapers, Angela instructed Kay to "Go into Alfs news agency over there and buy a map of the city."

She looked around for a seat. "It's the only way we'll ever find it. I know it's around here somewhere. When King Kong climbed up it in the original movie, it was the tallest building in the world."

Kay crossed the road and disappeared through the dark doorway. A few minutes later she came out and handed the map to Angela who opened it, spreading it out on her knees.

The two friends had arrived for their short holiday in New York and had set out on foot to see as much as they could.

Angela clicked her tongue and said, "Oh!" softly, as if to herself. "Well, it's quite a few blocks from here. Quite a walk. Here, look."

Kay studied the map. She found where they were at the moment and traced a path to their destination with her eyes. She looked back at the starting point.

"Well," she said cheerfully, looking down at her feet. "It's OK, I'm wearing the right shoes." "I've just had a thought," she said. "I could have saved six dollars by just asking Alf."

After a short silence, during which Angela folded the map carefully placing the segment that they would need on the outside, she had another thought.

"I think it's amazing that we couldn't find the Empire State Building."

- Is the Empire State Building the tallest building in the world? Why do you say that
- How much did the map cost?
- What sort of shoes do you think Kay was wearing?
- Why do you think they couldn't find the Empire State Building without the map?

REACTION QUESTION (Your answer must refer to the text)

- Would you like to go on holiday with Angela? Why do you say that?